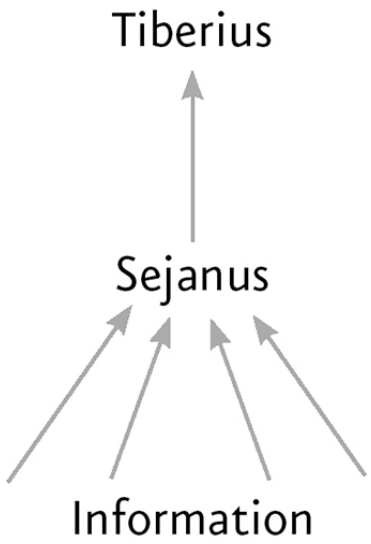
inform the Senate and the army that the emperor was too ill to travel anywhere.

Tiberius nevertheless managed to turn the tables on Sejanus. As Sejanus grew in power and became preoccupied with running the empire, he lost touch with the day-to-day minutiae of Rome's security apparatus. Tiberius managed to secretly gain the support of Naevius Sutorius Macro, commander of Rome's fire brigade and night watch. Macro orchestrated a coup against Sejanus, and as a reward Tiberius made Macro the new commander of the Praetorian Guard. A few years later, Macro had Tiberius killed.[14]



Power lies at the nexus where the information channels merge. Since Tiberius allowed the information channels to merge in the person of Sejanus, the latter became the true centre of power, while Tiberius was reduced to a puppet.

The fate of Tiberius indicates the delicate balance that all dictators must strike. They try to concentrate all information in one place, but they must be careful that the different channels of information are allowed to merge only in their own person. If the information channels merge somewhere else, that then becomes the true nexus of power. When the regime relies on humans like Sejanus and Macro, a skilful dictator can play them one against the other in order to remain on top. Stalin's purges were all about that. Yet when a regime relies on a powerful but inscrutable AI that gathers and analyses all information, the human dictator is in danger of losing all power.